

Monday, 7 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 23° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Drizzle 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 20° 15°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Tragedy has struck a family camping in Staffordshire, after a baby girl sadly died in a wooded area near Cheslyn Hay.

Police have confirmed a cordon remains in place as they investigate the circumstances. Our thoughts are with the family.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

Three people, including a teenager, have been charged with attempted murder following a shooting incident.

The two adults and the teenager are due to appear in court today. Police are continuing their investigations.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Our magnificent new aircraft carrier, HMS Queen Elizabeth, has set sail from Portsmouth Naval Base for a new training exercise.

The impressive vessel departed on Saturday evening. It's always a sight to behold as she heads out to sea.

DEFENCE · UK
- 4

Good news for travellers: train services to and from Heathrow Airport have now resumed after Saturday's major disruption.

A trackside fire caused severe delays and cancellations, with no trains running between central London and the airport for a time.

TRAVEL · UK
- 5

After a lovely burst of autumn warmth over the weekend, with temperatures climbing above 28 degrees, the heat is set to be short-lived.

Sunday saw summer-like conditions for many across the UK. However, the forecast suggests a return to more typical September weather.

WEATHER · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Comedian Munya Chawawa is making an exciting leap from social media to the stage, preparing for his Shakespearean acting debut.**
He's keen to move away from online content and embrace live performance. It'll be fascinating to see him tackle the Bard!

ON AIR – What classic role would you love to see Munya Chawawa take on?
THEATRE · COMING UP

- 2 The rumour mill is in overdrive about who will be the next James Bond, with an announcement potentially on the horizon.**
Speculation has been building for a while now about Daniel Craig's successor. Fans are eagerly awaiting news of who will take on the iconic 007 role.

ON AIR – Who do you think would make the perfect next James Bond?
FILM · COMING UP

- 3 History buffs rejoice! The epic Bayeux Tapestry, telling the story of the Norman Conquest, will soon be on display at the British Museum.**
This incredible 70-metre tapestry depicts the events leading up to the Battle of Hastings in 1066. It's a rare chance to see such a significant historical artwork.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen the Bayeux Tapestry? What historical artefact would you love to see up close?
EXHIBITION · COMING UP

- 4 K-Pop girl group Katseye, despite missing two members, still managed to dazzle their fans with a hero's welcome in London.**
The resilient group performed to an enthusiastic crowd. It shows their dedication and the strength of their fanbase.

ON AIR – Which band have you seen perform live, even with a reduced line-up, and still put on a brilliant show?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK

- 5 Victoria Beckham's fashion firm has finally turned a profit, nearly two decades after she launched her brand.**

The former Posh Spice has worked hard to build her fashion empire. It's a huge milestone for her business.
ON AIR – What celebrity brand have you been impressed by recently?
FASHION · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Manchester United boss Michael Carrick is trying to stay positive despite his side dropping more points in a draw with Everton.**

United drew 2-2 at Hill Dickinson Stadium after Everton rescued a point with a stoppage-time equaliser. Carrick admitted his side made decisions that made the game more difficult.

ON AIR – Are you feeling optimistic about Manchester United's season, or is it too early to tell?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England rugby star Maro Itoje is back in the national squad, named in a 36-man training camp ahead of the autumn Nations Championship.**

The second row's return will be a boost for the team. Fans will be eager to see him back in action for England.

ON AIR – How important is Maro Itoje to England's rugby team, in your opinion?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Sophia Dunkley's century helped England secure a comprehensive series sweep over Ireland in their one-day international cricket.**

England won by 114 runs in the third and final match at Worcester, completing a 3-0 series victory. A dominant performance from the home side.

ON AIR – What's been your highlight of England's cricket season so far?

CRICKET · UK

4 **England's Paul Casey was narrowly beaten in a play-off at the European Masters in Switzerland.**

Casey lost to South Africa's defending champion Thriston Lawrence on the fourth play-off hole. A tough way to finish, but a strong performance overall.

ON AIR – What's the most frustrating sporting defeat you've ever witnessed?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Irish boxing icon Katie Taylor has had an extraordinary swansong, cementing her place among the greats with a perfect farewell fight.**

Taylor retired after a unanimous decision victory over Flora Pili at a sold-out Croke Park in Dublin. She described the win as the 'highlight of my career'.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable sporting farewell you've ever seen?

BOXING · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 Many of us are finding joy in the simple act of 'doodling' during meetings or phone calls.**
Research suggests that these spontaneous scribbles can actually boost focus and aid memory recall. So, next time you're in a long meeting, feel free to let your pen wander!
- 2 The humble 'garden shed' is undergoing a stylish transformation, becoming much more than just a storage space.**
From 'she-sheds' to 'man caves' and even mini-offices, people are turning their sheds into personalised havens. It seems the little outbuilding is finally getting its moment in the sun!
- 3 A new trend sees people embracing 'vintage board games' for family nights.**
Dust off those classic boxes of Ludo or Monopoly! Families are finding retro games offer a charming, screen-free way to connect and create new memories together.
- 4 The art of 'upcycling old furniture' is gaining popularity, with stunning results.**
Instead of buying new, many are giving beloved but tired pieces a fresh lease of life with a lick of paint or new upholstery. It's good for the planet and creates unique treasures!
- 5 A delightful study reveals that 'watching documentaries about nature' can significantly improve mood.**
It seems a dose of David Attenborough or a peek into the wilderness from your sofa can be just the tonic for a brighter day. Time to get cosy with some captivating wildlife!
- 6 More people are discovering the meditative benefits of 'knitting and crocheting'.**
The rhythmic movements and creative process are proving to be a wonderful way to unwind and de-stress. Plus, you get a lovely scarf or blanket at the end of it!
- 7 The trend for 'homemade preserves and jams' is experiencing a sweet resurgence.**
From blackberry jam to tangy chutneys, many are enjoying the satisfaction of making their own delicious spreads. It's a taste of tradition and a lovely way to use seasonal produce.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: WE 'SHAKE THE BOX' AND LISTEN TO THE RATTLE OF THE FLAKES, HOPING FOR THAT PERFECT CRUNCH!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of coffee, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WE HAVE TO 'SMELL THE DRY COFFEE GROUNDS' DIRECTLY FROM THE BAG, TAKING A DEEP SNIFF BEFORE BREWING!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' in your home just seems to have a personality of its own, almost like a little character?**
Maybe it's that wobbly old armchair, or a kettle that sounds like it's singing! What everyday item in your home has developed its own quirky personality?

- **We all have those 'little personal traditions' we do on a Sunday, don't we, that just make the day feel right?**
Perhaps it's a specific breakfast, a leisurely walk, or a Sunday roast ritual. What are your beloved Sunday traditions that make the weekend complete?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that the 'puffin' is often referred to as the 'sea parrot' due to its brightly coloured beak during breeding season?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A new study has found that goldfish actually have a memory span of several months, not just a few seconds, and can even be trained to navigate simple mazes.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first adhesive postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840.
- A 'group of ferrets' is called a business.
- The 'human heart' creates enough pressure when it beats to squirt blood 30 feet.
- The 'Great Fire of London' in 1666 destroyed a large part of the city, but only a handful of deaths were officially recorded.
- The 'Eiffel Tower' can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron from the heat.
- The 'national animal of Scotland' is the unicorn.
- The 'oldest active lighthouse' in Britain is the Eddystone Lighthouse, off the coast of Cornwall, first lit in 1698.
- A 'group of ravens' is called an unkindness.

On this day

Day 250 of the year, 115 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Pakistan); Christian feast day: Anastasius the Fuller; Christian feast day: Clodoald; Christian feast day: Blessed Giovanni Battista Mazzucconi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — Miniminter, English YouTuber
- 1942 — Alan Oakes, English footballer and manager
- 1943 — Joe Simon, American singer-songwriter and producer, and preacher (died 2021)
- 1943 — Gloria Gaynor, American singer-songwriter
- 1961 — LeRoi Moore, American saxophonist and songwriter (died 2008)
- 1999 — Gracie Abrams, American singer-songwriter
- 1939 — Latimore, American singer-songwriter and pianist (died 2026)
- 1980 — J. D. Pardo, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is elected first secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1963 — The Pro Football Hall of Fame opens in Canton, Ohio with 17 charter members.
- 2017 — The 8.2 Mw 2017 Chiapas earthquake strikes southern Mexico, killing at least 60 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Maiden flight of the Lockheed Martin F-22 Raptor.
- 2010 — A Chinese fishing trawler collides with two Japanese Coast Guard patrol boats in disputed waters near the Senkaku Islands.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1986 — Chilean dictator Augusto Pinochet survives an assassination attempt by the FPMR; five of Pinochet's bodyguards are killed.
- 1979 — The Chrysler Corporation asks the United States government for US\$1.5 billion to avoid bankruptcy.

- 1970 — Fighting begins between Arab guerrillas and government forces in Jordan.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 251 of the year, 114 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Adrian and Natalia of Nicomedia (Roman Catholic Church); Christian Feast Day: Corbinian; Christian Feast Day: Disibod; Christian Feast Day: Blessed Frédéric Ozanam. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1934 — Bernard Donoughue, Baron Donoughue, English academic and politician
- 1994 — Nicky Walker, English professional footballer
- 1969 — Chris Powell, English footballer and manager
- 1968 — Ray Wilson, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1942 — Brian Cole, American bass player (died 1972)
- 1994 — Stuart Moore, English professional footballer
- 1990 — Jos Buttler, English cricketer
- 1939 — Guitar Shorty, American singer and guitarist (died 2022)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2016 — NASA launches OSIRIS-REx, its first asteroid sample return mission. The probe visited 101955 Bennu and returned with samples in September 2023.
- 1970 — Trans International Airlines Flight 863 crashes during takeoff from John F. Kennedy International Airport in New York City, killing all 11 aboard.
- 2004 — NASA's uncrewed spacecraft Genesis crash-lands when its parachute fails to open.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Gays in the military: US Air Force Tech Sergeant Leonard Matlovich, a decorated veteran of the Vietnam War, appears in his Air Force uniform on the cover of Time magazine with the headline "I Am A Homosexual". He is given a general discharge, later upgraded to honorable.
- 2025 — Balçova police station shooting: 4 people, including the perpetrator are killed an attack on a police station in Turkey.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar